MME PLATFORM

Information Architecture

Full Specification Document

Chat and Communication as the Core Operating Model

This document is the complete Information Architecture specification for the MmE platform — an event management system built for event agencies, their vendors, clients, sponsors, and attendees. It covers every structural decision made, every layer of the IA, and the reasoning behind each choice.

The document is organised in the order decisions were made: platform philosophy first, then user types, then the workspace and channel architecture, then each user group's specific IA, then the forms and task systems, and finally the open roadmap.

1. Platform Philosophy

1.1 The Core Thesis

MmE is an event management platform with communication at its core. Every other feature — forms, tasks, vendor management, event pipeline, project tracking — is secondary to and dependent on the communication layer. This is not a conventional event management tool with a chat feature added. It is a communication platform that has event management built into its structure.

The distinction matters architecturally. In a conventional event management platform, the database and project management tools are primary; communication is a notification layer on top. In MmE, the channel is the primary unit. Everything else — tasks, forms, documents, broadcasts — lives within or attaches to a channel.

> ★ **Why Communication First?**
>
> *The event industry's dominant operational failure mode is communication breakdown: a vendor not informed of a change, a client not updated on a delay, a crew member without the latest version of the run-of-show. The tools most event teams actually use are WhatsApp groups and email chains — not purpose-built event management software. MmE's thesis is that the right response to this is to build a communication system that is so well-structured for the event context that it replaces those informal tools entirely, rather than adding another database product to the stack.*

1.2 Three Architectural Principles

- **The Channel is the Atomic Unit.** Every conversation, document, task, and form belongs to a channel. Nothing meaningful exists outside a channel context. This is the same foundational decision Slack made — and it is the correct one for a collaboration-first product.
- **Event-Scoped by Default.** Every channel, form, task, and communication is scoped to a specific event. This is the primary way MmE differs from a general-purpose communication tool. A vendor conversation about Infosys Summit 2025 is permanently separate from a conversation about Wipro Retreat 2024, even if the same vendor is involved in both.
- **One Record, Role-Specific Views.** There is no double-entry in MmE. A vendor fills in a form and the agency sees the output. Both parties are looking at different views of the same underlying record. This eliminates the synchronisation problem that plagues teams managing the same information across multiple tools.

1.3 What MmE Is Not

- Not a replacement for the vendor's own internal tools. Vendors have their own WhatsApp groups, their own email, their own operations systems. MmE does not try to replace those.

It captures the output of their internal work — the confirmed decisions, the submitted deliverables, the acknowledged updates.

- Not a general-purpose CRM. MmE's data model is event-scoped. It is not designed to manage long-term customer relationships across years of interactions. It is designed to manage the dense, high-velocity communication of a specific event from lead stage to closure.
- Not a project management tool with a chat sidebar. The chat is the primary surface. Project management tools (tasks, Kanban, Gantt) are secondary surfaces accessible from the channel's right sidebar.

2. User Types

MmE has five user types. Each has a distinct relationship to the platform, a distinct level of access, and a distinct primary objective.

User Type	Relationship to Platform	Primary Objective	Access Level
Agency Employee	Primary user — pays for platform	Manage events, coordinate vendors, serve clients	Full — role-gated
Vendor / External	Secondary user — invited per event	Execute deliverables, communicate with agency	Tunnelled — event-scoped
Client / Host	Tertiary user — invited per event	Track progress, approve deliverables	Read + comment on designated channels
Sponsor	Tertiary user — invited per event	Manage activation, track ROI	Sponsor hub only
Attendee	End user — invited at registration	Navigate event, access programme	Attendee app only

This document covers the Agency Employee and Vendor/External user types in full. Client, Sponsor, and Attendee IAs are identified as open roadmap items.

3. Event Pipeline and Stage System

3.1 The Seven Stages

Every event in MmE moves through exactly seven stages in sequence. No event skips a stage. An event can only be in one stage at a time. Each stage has a distinct colour that appears consistently across the sidebar, the Events tab, the Overview lifecycle diagram, and any notification that references that event.

Stage	Colour	Hex	Operational Meaning
LEAD		#888888	Prospect or pitch in progress. Nothing committed.
CONFIRMED		#2471A3	Contract signed. Budget approved. Event is happening.
PLANNING		#D4AC0D	Active production. Vendors being sourced and contracted.
BUILDUP		#CA6F1E	All decisions locked. Countdown mode. High-risk window.
LIVE		#C0392B	Event is happening right now. Maximum urgency.
WRAPUP		#7D3C98	Event over. Strike, reconciliation, reporting in progress.
CLOSED		#1E8449	All tasks complete. Channels archived. On record.

3.2 Stage Transition Triggers

Stages do not advance automatically on a date. They advance when a defined condition is met and a designated person confirms the transition.

Transition	Trigger Condition	Confirmed By
Lead → Confirmed	Signed contract received + deposit invoice raised	Senior Organiser or Admin
Confirmed → Planning	Kickoff meeting complete + Event Manager assigned	Event Manager
Planning → Build-Up	All primary vendor contracts signed + ROS in final draft + registration live	Ops Lead
Build-Up → Live	Load-in begins OR event start date/time reached	System (auto) or Ops Lead (manual)
Live → Wrap-Up	Event end time passes	System (automatic)
Wrap-Up → Closed	Final report delivered + all invoices reconciled + feedback exported	Event Manager + Finance sign-off

3.3 Stage Visibility Across the Platform

The stage colour and label appear in four places consistently:

- **Sidebar event label:** "Infosys Summit ● [Yellow dot] ⚠3" — colour dot next to event name, unread alert count.
- **Events tab card:** Each active event card shows its colour dot and stage label prominently.
- **Overview lifecycle diagram:** A horizontal pipeline from Lead to Closed with events plotted below their current stage.
- **Channel header:** "# inf25-general | Event | ● ACTIVE T-22 days [Yellow]" — stage colour in the channel header.

4. Workspace Architecture

4.1 The Workspace as the Container

Borrowed from Slack's foundational architecture, the workspace is the atomic unit — the self-contained environment within which all channels, users, messages, forms, and tasks exist. MmE has one workspace per agency organisation. A vendor, client, or sponsor invited into an event gets a scoped view into that workspace, not their own separate workspace.

This single-workspace model keeps all event data in one searchable, administrable environment, while role-based access controls ensure that each user type sees only what they are authorised to see.

4.2 The Three Zones

Within the agency workspace, all channels are organised into three zones. These zones are structural — they are not just sidebar categories, they govern the lifespan, visibility, and administrative rules of every channel within them.

Zone	Contents	Lifespan	Who Can Access
Company Layer	Mandatory channels, department channels, knowledge channels	Permanent — never archived unless department disbanded	Agency employees only — based on role
Event Layer	Event-specific channel clusters (one cluster per event)	Temporary — archived T+14 days after event close	Agency team assigned to event + invited external parties
Personal Layer	1:1 DMs, group DMs, saved messages	Never automatically removed	The individual user only

5. Channel Architecture

5.1 Channel Types

MmE has four channel types. All four are variants of the same underlying Channel object — the same data model, the same message structure, the same threading behaviour. The differences are in access scope, persistence, and communication direction.

Internal Channels

Internal channels are agency-private. No vendor, client, or sponsor can ever see an internal channel. They include the permanent company channels and the internal event-scoped channels within each event cluster.

```
INTERNAL CHANNEL TYPES:

Mandatory (auto-joined):     company-general  |  company-wins  |  company-
random
Department (role-based):     dept-operations  |  dept-production  |  dept-
marketing
                             dept-finance  |  dept-logistics  |  dept-
registration
Knowledge (optional):        resource-templates  |  resource-vendors  |
resource-tools
Event-internal:              inf25-general  |  inf25-ops  |  inf25-production
                             inf25-registration  |  inf25-marketing  |  inf25-
finance
                             inf25-logistics  |  inf25-alerts
```

External Channels

External channels are shared between the agency and a specific external party — a vendor, sponsor, client, or venue. The external party sees only their own channel(s). They cannot see other vendors, other sponsors, or any internal agency channels. This is the Slack Connect model applied to the event context.

```
EXTERNAL CHANNEL NAMING CONVENTION:

  #[event-code]-vendor-[vendorname]      inf25-vendor-avsolutions
  #[event-code]-sponsor-[sponsorname]    inf25-sponsor-hdfc
  #[event-code]-client-[clientname]      inf25-client-infosys
  #[event-code]-venue-[venuename]        inf25-venue-tajpalace
```

Broadcast

Broadcast is a one-to-many, non-conversational channel type. The sender (Ops Lead or above) publishes a message to a defined audience. Recipients can acknowledge receipt but cannot reply in the broadcast itself. If a recipient has a question, they go to their specific external channel to ask it.

Every broadcast that requires acknowledgement displays a confirmation log to the sender — showing who has and has not acknowledged. Unacknowledged broadcasts from critical parties trigger a Tier 1 notification to the sender.

Direct Messages

DMs are private 1:1 or small group conversations between any two or more users with mutual platform access. For agency employees, DMs are unrestricted across the workspace. For vendors, DMs are restricted to their agency contacts for the events they are involved in.

5.2 Channel Naming Convention

The naming convention is not a suggestion — it is enforced by the system at channel creation. Every channel name follows a defined pattern that encodes the channel type, event, and function in the name itself.

Channel Type	Pattern	Example
Company mandatory	company-[function]	company-general
Department	dept-[department]	dept-operations
Knowledge	resource-[topic]	resource-templates
Event internal	[event-code]-[function]	inf25-ops
Event vendor	[event-code]-vendor-[name]	inf25-vendor-avsolutions
Event sponsor	[event-code]-sponsor-[name]	inf25-sponsor-hdfc
Event client	[event-code]-client-[name]	inf25-client-infosys
Event venue	[event-code]-venue-[name]	inf25-venue-tajpalace

5.3 Channel Lifecycle

Every channel has one of three lifespans. The system enforces archiving automatically when the trigger condition is met.

Lifespan	Channels	Archive Trigger
Permanent	All company-*, dept-*, resource-* channels	Never — manual admin action only

Event-scoped	All [event-code]-* channels	T+14 days after event Closed stage confirmed
Personal	All DMs and group DMs	Never automatically removed

⚠ **ARCHIVE VS DELETE**

Archived channels are never deleted. They are read-only, fully searchable, and permanently accessible. A vendor or agency employee can always search a closed event's channel history. The archive trigger converts the channel from active to read-only — it does not destroy any data.

6. Agency Information Architecture

6.1 Top Navigation

Three tabs. Fixed. Visible at all times.

Tab	Content	Primary Use
Overview	Event lifecycle diagram + activity feed + workspace summary	Morning orientation — what needs attention right now
Events	Active events list (with stage colours) + archived events	Event pipeline management and navigation
DMs	All direct messages across all events and contacts	Personal and bilateral communication

6.2 Left Sidebar Structure

Company channels are listed first (permanent backbone, low-frequency). Event channels are listed second (temporary, high-frequency, where the active work happens). DMs are listed third.

```
SIDEBAR — AGENCY VIEW

COMPANY — Workspace
  MANDATORY  (auto-joined)
    company-general  [locked: admin posts only]
    company-wins
    company-random
  DEPARTMENTS  (role-based)
    dept-operations
    dept-production
    dept-marketing
    dept-finance  [locked]
    dept-logistics
    dept-registration
  KNOWLEDGE  (optional self-join)
    resource-templates
    resource-vendors
    resource-tools

EVENTS — Event Channels
  Infosys Summit  [Yellow dot]  ⚠3
    inf25-general              3 unread
    inf25-ops                  1 unread
    inf25-production
    inf25-registration
```

```
    inf25-marketing
    inf25-finance              [locked]
    inf25-logistics
    inf25-alerts
  Wipro Retreat  [Orange dot]  ⚠1
    wipro-...
  + New Event

DMs
  Sofia Davis              2 unread
  Jackson Lee              1 unread
  Anita Verma (Client)
  Team Standup  [5]

[JD]  Jane Doe · Ops Coordinator  ⚙  ●
```

6.3 Overview Tab

The Overview tab is the agency employee's daily entry point. It answers the question: what needs my attention right now?

Section	Content	Purpose
Event Channel Lifecycle diagram	Horizontal pipeline Lead→Closed with all events plotted by current stage using colour dots	Instant visual status of entire event portfolio
Activity Feed	Unread messages, pending form stage reviews, unacknowledged broadcasts, overdue tasks	Action queue — what to do first
Company Channels	List of company-* and dept-* channels with member counts	Quick access to permanent backbone
Event Channels	List of active event clusters with channel counts and assignment status	Navigate to any event channel quickly

6.4 Events Tab

The Events tab shows only two sections: Active Events and Archived Events. There is no separate Pipeline or Closed view. Stage is communicated entirely through the colour dot system.

```
EVENTS TAB

ACTIVE EVENTS
  Infosys Summit 2025    [Yellow dot — PLANNING]   ⚠3
```

```
    T-22 days  |  8 members  |  4 vendors

  Wipro Retreat 2024     [Orange dot — BUILDUP]    ⚠1
    T-45 days  |  6 members  |  3 vendors

  Tech Forum 2026        [Grey dot — LEAD]
    T-180 days  |  2 members

ARCHIVED EVENTS
  TCS Offsite 2024       [Green dot — CLOSED]
  Annual Gala 2026       [Green dot — CLOSED]
  Decathlon Launch       [Green dot — CLOSED]
```

6.5 Channel View

Clicking any channel in the sidebar opens the channel view directly — no intermediate screen, no info panel blocking the messages. The channel view has four elements: the header, the message feed, the composer, and the right sidebar (slides in on demand).

Channel Header

```
# inf25-general  |  Event  |  ACTIVE — T-22 days  [Yellow]
[👤 Members]  [ℹ Channel Info]  [🔍 Search]  [≡ Sidebar]  [···]

Channel Info (opens as modal on ℹ click):
  WHO: All Infosys Summit 2025 team members
  PURPOSE: General coordination, updates, cross-functional comms
  RULES: Everyone assigned to this event sees this channel
  ROLE-BASED VISIBILITY:
    Event Manager    → all event channels
    Ops Coordinator  → #general, #ops, #logistics, #alerts
    Reg Coordinator  → #general, #registration, #alerts
```

Message Feed

The message feed is the dominant element. It is chronological, with threads collapsible under parent messages. Two message types exist in the feed: regular messages (visible to all channel members) and internal notes (visible to agency team only, visually distinct with a muted grey background and "Internal — not visible to external party" label).

Message Composer

```
[📎 Attach]  [😊 Emoji]  [@Mention]  [📝 Internal Note]
```

```
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
[Type a message...]                                  [Send]

Internal Note mode: composer background shifts to grey.
Message sends as internal-only, invisible to vendors/clients.
```

Right Sidebar — Slide-in Panel

The right sidebar slides in when the [≡] button is clicked in the channel header. It is scoped to the current channel — forms created here belong to this channel, tasks listed here are linked to this channel, members shown are members of this channel.

Section	Content	Actions Available
Overview	Channel name, event, stage, T-minus days	Read only
Tasks	All tasks linked to this channel, with status and due date	Add task, mark complete, assign
Forms	All forms published to this channel, with current stage progress	Create form, view form, fill stage
Pinned Documents	All files pinned to this channel, with version label	View, pin new, unpin
Members	All users with access to this channel, with role labels	Add member, view profile

6.6 DMs Tab

The DMs tab shows all direct messages across all events and contacts. The key design decision is the context tag beneath each name — showing their role, company, and event. This solves the Slack problem where a DM from an unknown name has no immediate context.

```
DM LIST ENTRY FORMAT:

  [Avatar]  Sofia Davis                                2m ago  [2]
            Event Manager · MmE Agency · Infosys Summit 2025
            "Can you share the updated venue layout?"

  [Avatar]  Anita Verma                                3h ago
            Client POC · Infosys Ltd. · Infosys Summit 2025
            "Approved the final agenda — looks great!"

FILTER TABS:  [All]  [Internal]  [External]  [Clients]  [Vendors]
SEARCH:       Search by name, role, company, or event...
```

```
+ New DM button always visible
```

7. Vendor / External Information Architecture

7.1 The Vendor's Relationship to the Platform

The vendor is a secondary user of MmE. They do not pay for the platform. They are invited into it on a per-event basis by the agency. Their view of the platform is intentionally limited — a tunnelled view that shows only what is relevant to their specific role in their specific event(s). They should never feel like they are looking at a restricted version of a larger system. Their portal should feel complete for what they need.

> ⚠ **THE DOUBLE-ENTRY PROBLEM — SOLVED**
>
> Vendors should never have to update the same information in two places. MmE solves this through the single record principle: there is one form record. The vendor fills it in. The agency sees the output. Both are looking at different views of the same object. The vendor's internal form work maps automatically to the agency's parent form stages. One action, one place.

7.2 Top Navigation — Vendor

Tab	Content	Difference from Agency
Overview	Active events with task summaries + recent activity	No full pipeline view — only their events
DMs	DMs with agency contacts + own team members	No filter by vendor/client — simplified

Note: No Events tab for vendors. Their event navigation is through the sidebar and the Overview event cards. My Tasks is not a separate tab — tasks are surfaced within each event board on the Overview.

7.3 Left Sidebar — Vendor

The vendor sidebar has three sections: Company (their own internal channels), Events (their event-scoped channels only), and DMs. The company section supports vendor internal communication without giving vendors visibility into the agency's structure.

```
SIDEBAR — VENDOR VIEW

COMPANY — Internal  (vendor's own channels)
  vendor-general
  vendor-ops
```

```
  vendor-random

EVENTS — Event Channels  (their channels only)
  Infosys Summit  [Yellow dot]   2 unread
    inf25-vendor-avsolutions

  Wipro Retreat  [Orange dot]
    wipro-vendor-avsolutions

DMs
  Priya Mehta · Ops Lead         1 unread
  Sofia Davis · Event Manager
  Ravi Kumar · AV Tech (internal)

[RS]  Rahul Sharma · AV Solutions  ⚙  ●
```

The vendor's company-internal channels are private to the vendor's own team. The agency cannot see them. This is the equivalent of Slack's own-workspace channels — a space for the vendor to coordinate internally without doing so in a channel the agency monitors.

7.4 Overview Tab — Vendor

The vendor Overview has three sections. The lifecycle diagram is read-only for context. The active events cards expand to show task summaries. Recent activity gives the vendor a quick action queue.

```
VENDOR OVERVIEW

EVENT CHANNEL LIFECYCLE  (read-only)
  LEAD ── CONFIRMED ── PLANNING ── BUILDUP ── LIVE ── WRAPUP ── CLOSED
                       [Infosys Summit]  [Wipro Retreat]
                       Yellow dot        Orange dot

ACTIVE EVENTS
  Infosys Summit 2025  [Yellow — PLANNING]
    T-22 days  |  Contact: Priya Mehta · Ops Lead
    [Open event board]

    ON CLICK — OPENS EVENT BOARD:
    ┌──────────────────────────────────────────┐
    | INFOSYS SUMMIT 2025  [Yellow]  T-22 days  |
    | Contact: Priya Mehta · priya@mmeevents.com |
    |                                          |
    | TASK SUMMARY                             |
    |  ⚠  Equipment checklist  Stage 3/4       |
    |     Due: Apr 5 — 3 days remaining        |
```

```
     │  ○  Load-in confirmation  Not started      │
     │     Due: Apr 10                            │
     │  ✓  Stage A: Tech specs  Complete          │
     │  ✓  Stage B: Equipment   Complete          │
     │  [Go to channel]                           │
     └────────────────────────────────────────────┘

 RECENT ACTIVITY
   New message from Priya in #inf25-vendor-avsolutions
   Broadcast: Load-in rescheduled  [Acknowledge]
   Stage B auto-marked complete ✓
```

7.5 Channel View — Vendor

The vendor channel view follows the same structure as the agency channel view: header, message feed, composer, right sidebar. The differences are in what the header shows, what the composer permits, and what the right sidebar contains.

Element	Agency View	Vendor View
Channel header	Channel name, type, stage, T-minus, all icons	Channel name, role (AV Vendor), stage, contact name
Info modal (ℹ click)	WHO, PURPOSE, RULES, role visibility breakdown	Role, contract status, deliverable, load-in time, event dates
Message composer	Attach, emoji, @mention, internal note	Attach, emoji only — no internal note (irrelevant to vendor)
Right sidebar — Forms	Agency forms + vendor form outputs + create form	Agency-assigned forms + own internal forms + create internal form
Right sidebar — Tasks	All tasks for this channel + add + assign	Own tasks for this channel + add internal task
Right sidebar — Members	All members with roles	Agency contacts + own team members in this channel

8. Vendor Journey Map

The vendor journey has five phases. Each phase has defined touchpoints, what the vendor does, what they feel, and where friction exists.

8.1 Phase 1 — Discovery and Invite

Element	Detail
Who initiates	Event Agency
Vendor status	Outside the platform entirely
Touchpoint	Receives invite email/link: event name, agency name, their role, event dates, [Accept] / [Decline]
Vendor feels	Oriented — context is clear before they do anything
Friction point	If the invite goes to the wrong contact (e.g., sales instead of ops), there is no handoff mechanism in V1

8.2 Phase 2 — Onboarding

Onboarding is two-stage by design. Platform onboarding first (company profile). Event workspace onboarding second (event-specific context). These are separate moments with different information needs.

Onboarding Stage	What Vendor Provides	What System Delivers
Platform onboarding	Company name, type, primary contact, designation, email, phone, city, team members	User profile created, company record created, ready to receive event invitations
Event workspace onboarding	Nothing — reads only	Event name, stage, their role, agency contact name, their channel, documents waiting, task list

8.3 Phase 3 — Active Coordination

The longest and most important phase. Spans from event confirmation to event day. The vendor communicates through their external channel, fills staged form records, and receives broadcasts.

Touchpoint	What Happens	Design Principle
Shared channel	Ongoing communication between vendor and agency. Pinned documents.	Single channel = single source of truth. No WhatsApp parallel.

	Threads for specific questions.	
Staged task forms	Vendor progresses through internal stages 1-4. Stage 4 (or mapped stage) auto-notifies agency.	One record, role-specific views, no double-entry.
Broadcast receipt	Agency sends update to all vendors. Vendor sees banner, taps Acknowledge. Agency sees confirmation log.	Acknowledgement is the key feature — agency knows who has/has not confirmed.

8.4 Phase 4 — Live Event Day

The vendor's interface strips to essentials on event day. The channel becomes an operational radio feed — short messages, fast acknowledgements, no document navigation.

- Mobile view shows: event name, stage (LIVE/Red), today's tasks, latest broadcast, quick access to channel and agency contact.
- Channel messages are brief and confirmatory: "Done", "3 mins", "On it".
- Broadcast acknowledgement remains active — critical updates still require confirmation.

8.5 Phase 5 — Post-Event and Offboarding

Touchpoint	Action	Outcome
Final task submissions	Vendor submits equipment return, damage report, final invoice through platform	Records locked, written to event master log
Feedback form	Vendor completes short agency feedback form (brief clarity, timeline, issues)	Stored on vendor's context panel for future events
Channel archiving (T+14)	System notifies vendor: channel is now read-only, history searchable, documents accessible	Clean closure, vendor profile updated with event history

Two gaps identified for V2 roadmap: invoice payment status is not visible to the vendor after submission; re-invitation for a known vendor should be accelerated (profile already exists, event-specific setup only).

9. Forms System

9.1 The Core Problem Forms Solve

Standard event management relies on email chains for vendor briefings, WhatsApp for status updates, and manual calls for confirmation. Every piece of information exists in multiple places, in different formats, with no shared record. Forms solve this by creating a single record that both parties update over time — not a document sent back and forth, but a living record with a status pipeline.

9.2 Form Types

Form Type	Created By	Filled By	Purpose
Standalone	Agency or Vendor	Designated users	Single-submission, no staging required
Parent Form	Agency	Vendor (stages visible to agency from Stage 4)	Multi-stage milestone tracking — agency sees output at defined thresholds
Child Form	Vendor	Vendor's own team	Internal work breakdown — final stage maps to parent form stage
Dashboard Form	Agency	Multiple channels simultaneously	Unified form published to multiple vendor channels from the dashboard

9.3 The Parent-Child Form Hierarchy

The parent-child form relationship is the most sophisticated feature in the MmE forms system. It allows vendors to manage their own internal work breakdown without the agency seeing it, while automatically updating the agency's milestone record when the vendor's internal work reaches the defined completion point.

How It Works

```
AGENCY PARENT FORM:
  Stages: A → B → C → D
  Published to: #inf25-vendor-avsolutions
  Agency sees: which stages are complete, when completed, by whom

VENDOR CHILD FORM:
  Stages: 1 → 2 → 3 → 4
  Lives in: vendor's internal channel
```

```
  Stage 4 mapped to: Stage B on parent form

TRIGGER CHAIN:
  Vendor completes Stage 4 on child form
    → System checks parent_stage_map: { stage-4 → stage-B }
    → Parent form Stage B: status = COMPLETED (auto)
    → Agency Ops Lead notification: "Stage B completed by AV Solutions"
    → Gantt chart: Stage B column → GREEN
    → Channel system message: "Task: Stage B — COMPLETED ✓"

WHAT AGENCY SEES:    Stage B complete. Timestamp. Auto-trigger note.
WHAT VENDOR SEES:    Their stage 4 complete. No double-entry required.
```

9.4 The Form Object

```
Form {
  id:                unique identifier
  title:             string
  created_by:        User (agency or vendor)
  channel:           channel this form lives in
  stages:            [ array of stage objects ]
  type:              [ Parent | Child | Standalone ]
  parent_form_id:    if Child — references parent form
  parent_stage_map: { child_stage_id → parent_stage_id }
  visibility:        who can see each stage
}
```

9.5 Stage Mapping Rules

- One-to-one mapping only: a child form stage can only map to one parent stage. A parent stage can only be mapped by one child form. (V1 constraint — prevents ambiguity about what triggered what.)
- Mapping is optional: vendors can keep their internal form completely unmapped and manually mark parent stages. Both modes produce the same output on the parent form.
- Agency can see the mapping exists, but cannot see the child form's internal content — only that the trigger fired and when.

9.6 Form Creation — Two Methods

Method	Where	Scope	Use Case
Channel sidebar	Right sidebar of any channel, Forms section, [+ Create]	Scoped to that channel only	Vendor-specific form, single-channel deliverable tracking

Dashboard	Events tab, event dashboard, Forms section	Select one or multiple channels	Unified form for multiple vendors simultaneously

10. Notification System

10.1 Three Tiers

Notification overload is the failure mode of all communication platforms. MmE's notification system is designed around three tiers with different delivery mechanisms and different urgency signals.

Tier	Trigger	Delivery	Can Override?
Tier 1 — Immediate	@mention, broadcast requiring acknowledgement, task stage update, URGENT-flagged message	Push notification + in-app badge + sound	Only by Do Not Disturb mode
Tier 2 — Batched	New message in accessible channel, new DM, broadcast not requiring acknowledgement	In-app only, digest every 30 minutes	Yes — per channel setting
Tier 3 — Passive	Resolved thread reopened, file shared, system messages	Seen on next visit only	N/A — no active delivery

10.2 Broadcast Acknowledgement Logic

Broadcasts that require acknowledgement have a distinct notification and tracking mechanism. The sender gets a real-time acknowledgement log — a list of all recipients with a checkmark when they acknowledge and a warning flag if they have not acknowledged within a defined window.

- Unacknowledged broadcasts after 30 minutes: recipient receives a Tier 1 reminder notification.
- Unacknowledged broadcasts after 60 minutes: sender receives a Tier 1 alert listing non-acknowledgers by name.
- On event day (Live stage): thresholds compress to 10 minutes and 20 minutes respectively.

11. Role-Access Matrix

The access matrix defines which channel types each role can see and post in. This is the governance layer that makes the tunnelled vendor view possible.

Channel Type	Org. Admin	Event Manager	Ops Coord.	Vendor	Client	Sponsor
#company-general	Full	Full	Full	None	None	None
#dept-[name]	Full	Own dept	Own dept	None	None	None
#[event]-general	Full	Full	Full	None	None	None
#[event]-ops	Full	Full	Full	None	None	None
#[event]-vendor-[x]	Full	Full	Full	Own channel only	None	None
#[event]-client-[x]	Full	Full	View only	None	Own channel only	None
#[event]-sponsor-[x]	Full	Full	None	None	None	Own channel only
DMs	Unrestricted	Unrestricted	Unrestricted	Agency contacts only	Agency contacts only	Agency contacts only
Broadcast (send)	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Broadcast (receive)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes (relevant)	Yes (relevant)	Yes (relevant)

12. Wireframe Decisions

The low-fidelity wireframes produced to date represent four key screens. The decisions made in those wireframes, and the reasoning behind them, are documented here as a reference for future design iterations.

12.1 Screen: Workspace Overview

Decision	Reasoning
Three-tab top navigation (Overview / Events / DMs)	Maps directly to the three zones: company layer, event layer, personal layer. Clean, learnable, exhaustive.
Event Channel Lifecycle diagram in Overview	Makes the pipeline visible at the workspace level. Morning orientation tool — anyone opening the platform sees all events and all stages at a glance.
Company Channels section below lifecycle diagram	Permanent backbone is reference material, not the active work surface. It belongs below the urgent lifecycle information.

12.2 Screen: Channel View

Decision	Reasoning
Channel info removed from main view — accessible via ℹ icon as modal	Chat is the primary surface. Description and rules are reference material consulted occasionally, not continuously. Removing it means messages are visible immediately on channel click.
Clicking channel in sidebar goes directly to chat	No intermediate screen. The channel IS the chat. This is the correct behaviour for a comm-first product.
Role-based visibility shown in info modal	Transparency about permission scope is valuable but not something users need to see on every visit.

12.3 Screen: DMs

Decision	Reasoning
Context tags (role · company · event) under each DM name	Solves the Slack problem where a DM from an unknown name has no context. In MmE, every relationship is event-scoped and role-defined.
Group DM shown as distinct entry type with member count	Group DMs are a separate interaction pattern from 1:1. Visual differentiation prevents confusion.
Search scoped to name, role, company, event	These are the four dimensions a user actually searches by in a multi-event environment.

13. Open Roadmap — Non-Discussed Parts

The following parts of the MmE platform have been identified but not yet specified. They represent the full scope of work beyond what this document covers.

13.1 Gaps Within Existing Discussed Areas

Area	Gap	Priority
User types	Client/Host journey, portal, and permissions	High
User types	Sponsor journey, hub, and ROI tooling	High
User types	Attendee journey, app, and registration flow	Medium
Agency IA	Agency company onboarding (not just individual employees)	High
Search	Cross-channel, cross-event, cross-object search architecture	High
Mobile	Full mobile app IA (only live-day vendor view defined so far)	Medium
Settings	Admin panel, workspace settings, user management	Medium
Audit trail	Change log structure, access logs, compliance records	Medium
Vendor journey	Invoice payment status visibility post-submission	V2
Vendor journey	Accelerated re-invitation for known vendors	V2

13.2 Entirely Undiscussed Modules

Module	Description	Priority
Registration and ticketing	Attendee registration forms, ticket tiers, payment collection, badge generation	High
Event website and public app	Public-facing event website builder and attendee-facing mobile app	High
Marketing and promotion	Multi-channel campaign tools, SEO, social media, hashtag engine	Medium
Budget management	Expense approval workflow, budget tracking, variance reporting	High
Payment and invoicing	Vendor invoice submission, payment tracking, reconciliation dashboard	High
Sponsor hub	Sponsor portal, activation planner, benefits	Medium

	catalogue, ROI dashboard	
Exhibitor management	Booth configurator, lead retrieval, freight logistics, power allocation	Medium
Catering management	BEO management, dietary tracking, service schedule, F&B reconciliation	Medium
Reporting and analytics	Post-event report builder, attendance analytics, engagement metrics	Medium
Integrations	WhatsApp, email, Google Calendar, external CRMs, Zapier/API	High
Security and access logs	RBAC audit, biometric check-in, incident logger, zone lockdown	Medium
Event Library	Archived event templates, searchable history, cloning for repeat events	Medium
Pricing and plan tiers	Agency subscription tiers, what each tier unlocks, vendor seat model	High
API layer	Public API for third-party integrations, webhook architecture, key management	Low

Appendix — Key Definitions

Term	Definition
Atomic Unit	The smallest self-contained element that holds all other elements inside it. In MmE, the workspace is the atomic unit.
Channel	The primary unit of communication in MmE. All conversations, documents, tasks, and forms belong to a channel.
Event-Scoped	Data or communication that belongs to a specific event and is isolated from data belonging to other events.
Tunnelled View	A deliberately limited view of the platform designed for a secondary user type (vendor, client, sponsor) that shows only what is relevant to their role.
Parent Form	An agency-created form with milestone stages. Vendors see their assigned stages and report progress. Agency receives notification at defined stage thresholds.
Child Form	A vendor-created internal form that maps one or more of its completion stages to a stage on a parent form. Enables automatic parent stage updates without manual vendor reporting.
Stage Mapping	The defined link between a child form stage and a parent form stage. When the child stage is completed, the parent stage is automatically updated.
Broadcast	A one-to-many non-conversational message sent by the agency to a defined audience. Recipients acknowledge receipt. Agency sees confirmation log.
Internal Note	A message within an external channel (vendor/client) that is visible only to the agency team. The external party cannot see it. Rendered in a visually distinct style.
Context Panel	The right sidebar that slides in on any channel. Contains overview, tasks, forms, pinned documents, and member list — all scoped to that specific channel.
Archive	The state a channel enters T+14 days after event closure. Read-only. Fully searchable. Never deleted.
Double-Entry	The problem of having to update the same information in two places. Eliminated in MmE through the single record principle.

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Communication at the core. Events as the context.